

categories by rolling out more products in the lower price bracket at the entry level. At the same time, it will continue its focus on the mid- and high-end segments which now contribute 70-80 per cent of its turnover. This comes at a time when the global slowdown has resulted in Sony India undertaking a downward revision of its FY08 targets.

The company is expected to close this year with a 20-25 per cent growth, as compared to its earlier projections of 30-35 per cent. In 2007-08, Sony India's turnover was Rs 30 billion.

Usha to enter the LED segment

Usha Shriram, one of India's leading small appliance makers, plans to enter the light-emitting diode (LED) lighting products segment. It proposes to import such lighting products from Europe and market them under its own brand name.

The company's mission is to position its LED portfolio in the consumer segment and launch them at more compelling rates than the compact fluorescent lamp (CFL) range.

LG plans to launch 35 LCD models by year-end

LG Electronics India plans to launch 35 models of LCD TVs by this year-end. It also plans to introduce the in-plane switching (IPS) technology to its entire prospective of LCD lineup above 56 cm.

With IPS technology in all its LCDs here, the company aims to establish itself as the technology leader attaining a market share of 33 per cent in the LCD segment in 2009.

The IPS technology enhances motion-picture-consistent colours from all viewing angles and consumes less power. Also IPS panel are most appropriate for touch-panel applications.

Samsung unveils mobile movie store

Samsung Electronics has introduced a new mobile service called 'Movies' that enables mobile users to buy or rent



A clip from Aircel's promotional campaign of its GSM services in Delhi

movies and TV series online which can then be downloaded on their mobile devices. It is currently offering over 500 blockbusters from studios like Warner, Paramount and Universal.

Samsung Movies is currently available in Britain and Germany. The company is planning to expand it to other European markets in the coming months.

HP starts notebook manufacturing in India

Hewlett Packard (HP) has started manufacturing business notebooks in India. The company feels a local unit will help it to service its sales channel and clients faster and also provide flexibility to its supply chain in India. It has set up the business notebook manufacturing line at its Pantnagar facility.

"The decision is based on the huge market potential and the need to be closer to our sales channel," said Anurag Arora, country manager-business notebooks, personal systems group, HP India.

Aircel starts GSM services in Delhi

Delhi has got its seventh mobile operator with Aircel—a 76:24 joint venture between Malaysia's Maxis Communication Bhd and India's Apollo Hospital—launching its GSM services in the

city. Aircel will offer a lifetime validity scheme for prepaid mobile customers that allows users to make local calls at Re 1 for the first minute, 60 paise for the second minute and 40 paise for the third minute onwards.

With new entrants pouring into the market, Delhi's other six mobile operators, namely, Airtel, Vodafone, Idea, MTNL, Tata and Reliance, may also be forced to improve their tariff plans in days ahead.

Neoteric to sell NEC's multimedia projectors

NEC India has appointed Neoteric Infomatique as its national distributor-channel sales for its entire range of business projectors. This appointment is part of the company's business strategy to meet the rising sales of projectors in the Indian market.

Neoteric Infomatique is the national distributor for vendors like Apple, BenQ, Omega, Samsung, HP, Lenovo and Logitech, amongst others. It has pan India presence and penetration into over 350 cities and over 7500 channel partners.

BPL Mobile is now Loop Mobile

BPL Mobile has changed its name to Loop Mobile. The company's corporate identity has undergone a complete overhaul to mark growth and reinforce